1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of the Software Requirements Specification (SRS) is to describe the requirements for Gold Star, a web based productivity and habit building platform. This document defines what the system in intended to do, who it is intended for, and the characteristics of its users. It serves as a common reference for the our team and the instructor so everyone has a shared understanding of the product before and during development.

1.2 Scope

The primary goal of Gold Star is to help individuals with ADHD or ADHD like traits develop and maintain consistent routines. The platform aims to help users organize their schedules, break down tasks into manageable pieces, and build sustainable routines that last longer than a few days. A central goal is to provide structure while still allowing users to adapt their schedules so that changes in a user's day do not cause their routines to fall apart.

Gold Star benefits users by making it easier to start tasks, stay on track, and follow through with their daily routines. It reduces the burden of creating new schedules, which otherwise requires users to spend time determining tasks and estimating uncertain timeframes. It also helps address common obstacles such as forgetting what needs to be done and being tired and feeling down and being ashamed of not completing tasks. Because the platform allows schedules to adapt, users are better able to handle routine adaptations without abandoning their routines. That can lessen the frustration, anxiety, avoidance, and reduced self efficacy those disruptions often cause.

1.3 Definitions, Acronyms, and Abbreviations

Activity Alternation – Switching from an activity requiring high mental focus to an activity requiring low mental focus.

Activity Switching – The cognitive process of disengaging from one task and shifting mental focus to another task.

Adaptive Scheduling – To schedule a task which can be completed anytime within a set timeframe. For example, a task which can be completed anywhere inclusively between 7:00 P.M. and 10:00 P.M.

Application Programming Interface (API) - A set of standard rules, protocols, and definitions allowing different software applications to interact with one another.

Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD) - A common neurodevelopmental disorder that alters the brain's ability to plan, focus, remember instructions, and manage emotions.

Cascading Style Sheets (CSS) - A style sheet language used to determine the visual presentation, layout, and aesthetics of a website.

Git - A digital version control system intended to preserve a history of saved modifications, additions, and deletions to software source code.

GitHub - A cloud-based platform where developers can collaborate on software code.

Gold Star - A web-based habit-building and time management platform designed specifically for individuals with ADHD.

Habit Stacking – Interspersing new habits with existing habits to make task completion easier without feeling overwhelmed.

Hyperactivity - A state of being unusually or abnormally active.

HyperText Markup Language (HTML) - The standard markup language used to create and

structure webpages. Gold Star Allen et al. 9

JavaScript (JS) - A lightweight programming language used to build dynamic interactivity on web pages. Gold Star Bucher 8

Jest - An open-source JavaScript testing framework.

JSDoc - An API documentation generator and syntax standard for JavaScript.

Pomodoro Technique – A time-management technique which separates work into 25-minute increments and 5-minute breaks. The standard Pomodoro process repeats this technique 4 times, then a longer break between 20 to 30 minutes is taken before the process repeats.

PostgreSQL - An open-source RDBMS that stores, manages, and retrieves data.

Reinforce - To make something stronger, more effective, or more compelling by adding support.

Relational Database Management System (RBMS) - Software used to store, manage, query, and retrieve data structured in table form.

Rigid Scheduling – To schedule a high-priority task which must either be initiated at or completed before an established time. For example, a task which must start at 6:00 P.M. or must be completed by a deadline of 6:00 P.M.

Routine Adaption – A requirement for an individual to change one's schedule or create new routines.

Routine - A sequence of actions regularly followed, or a fixed program.

Task Deviation – When a task has an unexpected change regarding completion. A task may be accomplished out of order in one's schedule, or it may not be accomplished at all.

Visual Studio Code (VSCode) - A development environment used for software engineering and web development.

1.4 References

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1.5 Overview

The remainder of this SRS consists of Section 2, Overall Description, which provides a high level view of Gold Star. Section 2.1 describes the product perspective, including the problem Gold Star addresses and its overall purpose. Section 2.2 outlines the main functions of the platform. Section 2.3 defines the user characteristics, including the single registered user role and the skills expected of users. Section 2.4 & 2.5 address constraints and assumptions and dependencies for the products, which now are not applicable.

2 Overall Description

2.1 Product Perspective

Gold Star is a web based productivity and habit building platform designed primarily for individuals with ADHD who struggles to create and maintain routines. It addresses common difficulties with organization, time management, and daily responsibilities by combining scheduling, task management, habit building techniques, and productivity features in one system. The platform provides a low stakes environment where users can monitor their tasks, schedules, and habits without becoming overwhelmed. It also gives them the flexibility to adapt to missed tasks and changing priorities. The overall purpose of Gold Star is to make routine development and maintenance more manageable for users who struggle with consistency.

2.2 Product Functions

The main functions of the platform is to create, manage, and organize tasks. The features make it easier for users to maintain a steady routine with the tasks they know they need and can adjust the time frame, priority and other information about their tasks without being penalized and without the dread of disappointing someone.

2.3 User Characteristics

Gold Star has a single user role, the registered user. Anyone who wants to use the platform must create an account and log in. All users have the same level of access and there are no administrator or guest roles.

The registered user is expected to be the individual with ADHD or ADHD like traits who struggles with creating and maintaining routines. These users may have difficulty with focus, memory, time estimation, and starting or following through on tasks. As a result, the platform is designed to be simple, low stakes, and not overwhelming, very user friendly.

Once logged in, users can create, edit, and delete their own tasks, schedules, and habits. They can break larger tasks into smaller steps, track their progress and adjust their routines when tasks are missed or set a higher priority level for more important tasks. Each user can assess and manage only their data.

Registered users are expected to have basic computer and web browsing skills. No specialized technical knowledge is required to use Gold Star.

2.4 Constraints

N/A.

2.5 Assumptions and Dependencies

N/A.